

International Islamic University Chittagong

Center for General Education

Lesson Plan of URED 2302(Sciences of *Qu`ran* and *Hadith*)

Part-A: Basic Information		
1	ISCED Code:	0221
2	Course Code :	URED-2302
3	Course Title:	Sciences of Qur'an and Hadith
4	Course Type	GED
5	Year/Level/Semester/Term	3rd
6	Academic Session:	Autum23
7	Course Teacher/Instructor:	Mohammad Jaweed Iqbal
8	Pre-requisite (If any):	No
9	Credit Value	1
10	Contact Hours:	2
11	Notional Hours	40
12	Total Marks:	100
13	Rationale of the Course	The Holy Qur'an and Hadith are the main sources of Islamic Knowledge. They are the primary sources of Islamic Aqidah, Ibadah, Muamalah and Akhlaq. So after taking basic beliefs exactly from them and acquiring comprehensive knowledge about 'Ibadah, it is necessary to know the method of explanation and understanding the Holy Qur'an and Hadith in order to apply them in our worldly life. Thus this course is designed to make the students familiar with these two primary sources of Islamic knowledge and help them to remove any

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		misconception prevailing in the society concerning with or contrary to the spirit of the Qur'an and Hadith by establishing their authenticity and superiority.		
14	Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) and Mapping of CLOs with Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs) (Note: If required add /delete columns or rows)			
	SL	Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) Upon the successful completion of the course, students will be able to :	PLOs	Bloom's taxonomy domain/level
	CLO1	To understand the basic knowledge of the holy Quran and Sunnah as the last revelation of Allah (SWT) that will provide a clear idea on life and will develop moral standers of human life and society.	PLO8	Cognitive/ Understand
	CLO2	To understand the text of the holy Quran and Hadith based on their general and specific contexts and to analyze why Shariah does not accept any change or modification by human kind.	PLO12	Cognitive/ Analyze
	CLO3	To understand the miraculous nature of the holy Quran, and how the Sunnah classified from various angles to find out authentic Hadith.	PLO12	Cognitive/ Understand
Part-B:				
15.Course plan specifying content, CLOs, Co-curricular activities (if any), teaching learning and assessment strategy mapped with CLOs				
Week	Topic	Teaching-Learning Strategy	Assessment Strategy	Corresponding CLOs
Lecture-1 Week-1	(1) Definition of the Sciences of the Qur'an Literally and Terminologically (2) Definition of the Qur'an Literally and Terminologically	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	Class Test	CLOs-1

Lecture-2 Week-1	(3) Various Names and Attributes of the Holy Qur'an and their Significance	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	Class Test	CLOs-1
Lecture-3 Week-2	(4) Characteristics of the Holy Qur'an (5) Central Subject Matter & the Main Themes of the Holy Qur'an	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	Class Test	CLOs-1
Lecture-4 Week-2	(6) The necessity of the Holy Qur'an (7) The authenticity of the Holy Qur'an.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	Class Test	CLOs-1
Lecture-5 Week-3	Tutorial	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion		
Week-3	Class Test			
Lecture-6 Week-4	(1) Meaning of Wahi (2) Various classifications and procedure of Wahi	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	Mid term	CLOs1
Lecture-7 Week-4	3) Stages of revelation of the Holy Qur'an (4) Gradual revelation of the Holy Qur'an and the wisdom behind it	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	Mid term	CLOs1
Lecture-8 Week-5	The First and the Last Revelation.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	Mid term	CLOs1
Lecture-9 Week-5	(1) The Aayah of the Qur'an: Definition of Aayah. The Number of Ayah, words and letters of the Holy Qur'an. The Arrangement of the Ayah of the Holy Qur'an	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	Mid term	CLO2

Lecture-10 Week-6	(2) The Surah of The Qur'an: Definition of Surah. The Arrangement of Surah of the Holy Qur'an. The classification of Surah of the Holy Qur'an.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	Mid term	CLO2
Lecture-11 Week-6	Review			
Mid-Term Examination: 30 marks, Time: 1.5hrs; three questions to be answered. Each question will carry 10 marks. There may be two/ three parts in each question				
Lecture-12 Week-7	(1) Makki&Madani Revelations: (a) The Definition of Makki and Madani (b) The Characteristics of Makki and Madani Revelations (	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO2
Lecture-13 Week-7	The Characteristics of Makki and Madani Revelations (c) The benefits of knowing Makki and Madani Revelations.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO2
Lecture-14 Week-8	Meaning and classification of Asababunnuzul.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO2
Lecture-15 Week-8	classification of Asababunnuzul, The benefits of Knowing Asbanunnuzul.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO2
Lecture-16 Week-9	Al-Naskh (Abrogation) Definition, The proofs, The Classifications of Naskh.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO2
Lecture-17 Week-9	The Classifications of Naskh. The benefits of knowing Nasikh(abrogating) and Mansukh	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class	SEE	CLO2

	(abrogated) verses.	discussion		
Lecture-18 Week-10	Transmission of Quranic Revelation: (1) Types of transmission of Quranic revelation: Verbal Transmission & written form of transmission (2) Collection and compilation (Jam`ul Quran)	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO3
Lecture-19 Week-10	(3) Stages of collection (4) difference between collection of Abu Bakr (ra) and Othman (ra).	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO3
Lecture-20 Week-11	I`jaz al-Quran (Inimitability of The Holy Qur'an):</b> Definition of I`jaz, Condition, The Proofs of I`jaz.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO3
Lecture-21 Week-11	Various aspects of I`jaz Al-Qur'an.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO3
Lecture-22 Week-12	General Information About Sunnah and Hadith: (1) Definition of Hadith (2) Difference among Qur'an, Hadith and Hadith Qudshi (	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO1
Lecture-23 Week-12	3) The Position, importance and authority of Hadith in Islamic Shari'ah	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO1
Lecture-24 Week-13	(4) history of Collection & Compilation of Sunnah.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class	Assignment	CLO1

		discussion		
Lecture-25 Week-13	(1) Explanation of some important terms of Sunnah: Isnad/Sanad, Matn, Rawee and Riwayah, Al-jame‘, Al-Musnad, Al-Sahih, Al-Sunan, Sahihayn, Muttafaqun ‘Alayh, Al-kutub As-Sittah...etc.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO3
Lecture-26 Week-14	(1) Explanation of some important terms of Sunnah: Isnad/Sanad, Matn, Rawee and Riwayah, Al-jame‘, Al-Musnad, Al-Sahih, Al-Sunan, Sahihayn, Muttafaqun ‘Alayh, Al-kutub As-Sittah...etc.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO3
Lecture-27 Week-14	(2) The classification of Hadith: (a)According to the reference to a particular authority (b) According to the links in the Isnad(c) According to the number of narrators involved in each stage of the Isnad(d) According to the reliability and memory of the narrator.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO3
Lecture-28 Week-15	(3) Fabrication in Hadith: (a) Definition of Fabrication (b) Causes and consequence of fabrication (c) Some examples of commonly used fabricated Hadith in our society.	Lecture, White Board Writing,, Zoom, Power point Presentation, Q/A, Class discussion	SEE	CLO3
Lecture-29 Week-15	Review			
Final Examination: 50 marks; Time 2.5 hrs, five questions to be answered. Each question will carry 10 marks. There may be two/ three parts in each question				
Part-C:				

16. Assessment & Evaluation:						
1						
	Bloom's Category		Evaluations out of 100 marks			
			CIE (50 marks)			SEE (50marks)
	Cognitive learning	Affective Learning	Mid-term: (30)	Assignment/ Class Test: (10)	Attendance Marks :(10)	Written Exam: (50)
	Remember	-	-	-	-	5
	Understand	-	5	5		5
	Apply	-	5	-	-	5
	Analyze	-	10	-	-	15
	Evaluation	-	5	5	-	10
	Create	-	5	-	-	10
	x	Responding	x	x	10	
2	2.Marks distribution:					
	a) Continuous Assessment(CIE):		Class attendance Class test/ quizzes/assignments			10
			Mid term			10
						30
	b) Semester End Examination (SEE) 50					50
	Total					
			Total			100

3	Make-up Procedures as per IIUC exam rules
Part-D :	
17. Learning Materials:	
a) Qadhi, Yasir, Abu Ammar. 'An Introduction to Sciences of the Qu`an'	
b) Hasan, Dr.Suhaib, An Introduction to the Science of Hadith, London, AL-Qur'an Society, 1994.	
18. Recommended Readings :	
<u>Sciences of Qur'an:</u>	
1. Denffer, Ahmad, vol. 'UlamAl-Qur'an:An Introduction to the Sciences of the Qur'an, The Islamic Foundation, UK, reprinted by – A.S. Noordeen, Kuala Lumpur. 1983.	
2. Ushama, Dr.Thameem, Sciences of the Qur'an: An Analytical Study, International Islamic University Malaysia, Cooperative Limited, Kuala Lumpur. 1998.	
3. Bucaille, Dr. Maurice, The Bible The Qur'an & Science, Thinkers Library, Selangor Darul Ehsan. Malaysia, 1996.	
4. Badruddin Muhammad bin Abdullah Al-Badruddin Al- Zarkashi, Al-Burhan Fi UlumilQur'an, Dar Al- Marifah, Bairuth, VI. 01.	
5. A Study of the Holy Qur'an and its Teachings, First edition, IQRA International Education Foundation, Chicago, April-1999.	
<u>Sciences of Hadith:</u>	
1. Al-Azami, Dr Mohammad Mustafa, Studies in Early Hadith Literature, American Trust publication, Indiana, 1978	
2. Marhribi, Al-Hassan, Introduction to the Study of the Hadith, Roshmee, South Africa, Roshmee Islamic School, 1994.	
3. Salih, Muhammad Adeeb, Lamahat fee Usul al-Hadeth, Damascus, 1393 AH.	
4. Siddiqi, Muhammad Zubayr, Hadith Literature: its Origin, Development & Special	

Chapter -1

1. Definition of the *Qur'an* Literally and Terminologically:

Definition of the *Qur'an* Literally:

Scholars of sciences of Quran have differed in Quran whether it is a proper noun or a derivative. Imam Shafiee says it is a proper noun while others say it is a derivative. As a derivative, the Arabic word Qur'an can be derived from the following roots.

Firstly, It can be derived from the root word qara'a (قرأ) which means to read, to recite. Qur'an is a verbal noun and hence, means the reading or recitation. We get this meaning from the usage of the Qur'an. Qur'an says:

(إن علينا جمعه وقرآنه - فإذا قرأناه فاتبع قرآنه - القيامة-17-18)

“It is for us to collect and to recite it. But when we have recited it, then follow its recitation”.

On the basis of this meaning the Quran is called Quran , because it is most widely read book in the world. We read it in prayers, educational institute and many other places for different purposes.

Secondly, it can be derived from the root word qarana(قرن) meaning a union or conjunction. Imam FakrAd Deen Razi quotes Imam Sufyan Sourī as stating that the Quran was given its own special name , because letters are joined to make word, words are joined to make surahs and surahs are joined to make Quran.

Some scholars say , the Quran is named with this name, because it combines the substances of previous heavenly books , rather it combines all the branches of knowledge. In this regard Allah(SWT) says: (ما فرطنا في الكتاب من شيء - الانعام-38)

“Nothing have we omitted from the book”.

Thirdly, it can be derived from the root word Qara'in (قرائن) which is the plural of Qarinah (قريضة). It means evidence, argument etc. In the Quran, we see that one verse interprets and gives arguments and evidences for another verse. So, Quran is called Quran.

✓ Definition of the *Qur'an* Terminologically: The Quran can be defined as follows:

The speech of Allah, sent down upon the last Prophet Muhammad (SAW), through the angel Gabriel, in its precise meaning and precise wording, transmitted to us by numerous persons (tawatur) both verbally and in writing.

2. The various Names of the *Qur'an*:

The holy Quran has many other names. From these names, some are original some are attributive. The both categories are mentioned in the below:

Original names of the Holy Quran:

- 1) الكتاب-Al-Kitab-The Scripture
- 2) الفرقان-Al-Furqan-The Criterion
- 3) الذكر-Ad-Dhikr-The Reminder
- 4) التنزيل-At-Tanzeel-The Revelation

Attributive names of the Holy Quran:

- 1) البرهان-Al-Burhan-The Proof
- 2) الحكيم-Al-Hakeem-The Judicious
- 3) المجيد-Al-Majeed-The Glorious
- 4) المبين-Al-Mubeen-The Perspicuous
- 5) العظيم-Al-Azeem-The Grand
- 6) النور-An-Nur-The Light
- 7) المهيمن-Al-Muhaimin-The Guard
- 8) الحق-Al-Haq-The Truth
- 9) النبأ-An-Naba-The Message
- 10) البلاغ-Al-Balag-The Message
- 11) المكنون-Al-Maknoon-The Well guarded
- 12) الكريم-Al-Kareem-The Honorable
- 13) الشفاء-As-Shifaa-The Healing
- 14) البشراي-Al-Bushraa-The Glad tidings

- 15) (المنذر\النذير) Al-Mundhir/An-Nadheer-The Warner
- 16) (المبارك) Al-Mubarak-The Blessed
- 17) (الهدى) Al-Hudaa-The Guidance
- 18) (الرحمة) Ar-Rahmah-The Mercy
- 19) (المصدق) Al-Musaddiq-The Confirming

3.Characteristics of the holy Quran: It is the blessing of Allah (SWT)that He has made the Quran distinguished from other revealed and unrevealed books by a number of characteristics. Some of the characteristics are as follows:

1. Speech of Allah(SWT):The holy Quran is the speech of Allah in Arabic language.It is not the speech of Jibreel nor Mohammad (SAW).It was revealed to Prophet(SAW) through Jibreel over a period of Twenty three years. Allah (SWT)says:

وَإِنَّهُ لَنَنْزِيلُ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ (192) نَزَلَ بِهِ الرُّوحُ الْأَمِينُ (193) عَلَى قَلْبِكَ لِتَكُونَ مِنَ الْمُنْذِرِينَ (194) بِلِسَانٍ عَرَبِيٍّ

مُبِينٍ

And indeed, the Qur'an is the revelation of the Lord of the worlds. The Trustworthy Spirit has brought it down Upon your heart, [O Muhammad] - that you may be of the warners - In a clear Arabic language.

2. Greatest Miracle: Allah has sent many prophets with miracles as proof of their prophet-hood. Mohammad (SAW) was the last prophet, who was given many miracles and the Quran is the greatest of his miracles. Allah says:

وَقَالُوا لَوْلَا أُنْزِلَ عَلَيْهِ آيَاتٌ مِنْ رَبِّهِ قُلْ إِنَّمَا الْآيَاتُ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ وَإِنَّمَا أَنَا نَذِيرٌ مُبِينٌ (50) أَوَلَمْ يَكْفِهِمْ أَنَّا أَنْزَلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ يُتْلَى عَلَيْهِمْ إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَرَحْمَةً وَذِكْرَى لِقَوْمٍ يُؤْمِنُونَ

But they say, "Why are not signs sent down to him from his Lord?" Say, "The signs are only with Allah, and I am only a clear Warner." And is it not sufficient for them that We revealed to you the Book which is recited to them? Indeed in that is a mercy and reminder for a people who believe.

These verses mention that the Quran itself is the miracle which is sufficient as miracle.

3. Protected from change and alternation: The holy Quran will remain unchanged and protected from any sort of alternation unlike the previous heavenly books. Allah Himself is the protector of this book. He says:

إِنَّا نَحْنُ نَزَّلْنَا الذِّكْرَ وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ (9)

“Verily We: It is We Who have sent down the revelation and surely, We will guard it (from corruption).”

The previous Books, such as the Torah and the Gospel, were changed and altered by the Jews and Christians.

4. Free from contradiction: The holy Quran contains no contradictions, despite it having been revealed over a period of twenty three years, in different circumstances, catering to different problems. The Quran challenges:

أَفَلَا يَتَذَكَّرُونَ الْفُرْقَانَ وَلَوْ كَانَ مِنْ عِنْدِ غَيْرِ اللَّهِ لَوَجَدُوا فِيهِ اخْتِلَافًا كَثِيرًا

Then do they not reflect upon the Qur'an? If it had been from [any] other than Allah, they would have found within it much contradiction.

The lack of contradiction in it is a clear indication of its divine origin.

5. Beyond produce and mimicry: No one will be able to produce and mimic a thing similar to Quran until the day of resurrection. Allah says:

وَإِنْ كُنْتُمْ فِي رَيْبٍ مِمَّا نَزَّلْنَا عَلَىٰ عَبْدِنَا فَأْتُوا بِسُورَةٍ مِثْلِهِ وَادْعُوا شُهَدَاءَكُمْ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ صَادِقِينَ (23) فَإِنْ لَمْ تَفْعَلُوا وَلَنْ تَفْعَلُوا فَاتَّقُوا النَّارَ الَّتِي وَقُودُهَا النَّاسُ وَالْحِجَارَةُ أُعِدَّتْ لِلْكَافِرِينَ

(23) And if you are in doubt about what We have sent down upon Our Servant [Muhammad], then produce a surah the like thereof and call upon your witnesses other than Allah, if you should be truthful.

(24) But if you do not - and you will never be able to - then fear the Fire, whose fuel is men and stones, prepared for the disbelievers.

6. Influential power: The holy Quran has an influential power on those who listen it. No person can remain unaffected after he has listened to it. The Quran itself describes its effect on listeners in many verses. Allah (SWT) says:

وَقَالَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا لَا تَسْمَعُوا لِهَذَا الْقُرْآنِ وَالْغَوْا فِيهِ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَغْلِبُونَ

(26) And those who disbelieve say, "Do not listen to this Qur'an and speak noisily during [the recitation of] it that perhaps you will overcome."

7. Easy to memorize: There is not a single practicing Muslim on the face of earth except that he has memorized some portion of Quran. This is because of the ease and great emphasize laid by Islam on memorizing the holy Quran. The Quran says:

وَلَقَدْ يَسَّرْنَا الْقُرْآنَ لِلذِّكْرِ فَهَلْ مِنْ مُدَكِّرٍ

And We have certainly made the Qur'an easy for remembrance, so is there any who will remember?

From this verse, it is understood that the holy Quran has been made easy to recite, memorize and understand.

8. A witness and dominant over other heavenly books: The holy Quran supersedes and overrules all other books revealed before it. This Book has combined the virtues of the Books that preceded it and was endowed with more perfection than them. This is why Allah has made the Quran a witness, trustworthy and dominant above all of the previous Books. Allah says:

وَأَنْزَلْنَا إِلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ بِالْحَقِّ مُصَدِّقًا لِمَا بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ مِنَ الْكِتَابِ وَمُهَيْمِنًا عَلَيْهِ

And We have revealed to you, [O Muhammad], the Book in truth, confirming that which preceded it of the Scripture and as a criterion over it.

4. Central Subject-matter of the holy Quran: The subject matter of the Qur'an is essentially **Man**. Man in relation to his Lord and Creator (Allah), Man in relation to himself, and Man in relation to the rest of the creation.

5. The Main Theme of the Quran: Main theme for a Man that runs throughout the Qur'an is that Allah alone deserves worship and that man should submit to Allah's laws in his personal life and in his relationship with Allah's creation in general. In other words, the main theme is a call to belief in Allah and to do the righteous deeds as defined by Allah.

If the reader keeps in mind these basic facts, he or she will find that from the beginning to the end, the Qurans basic topics are all closely connected to its main theme. The Qur'an keeps the

same object in view, whether it is describing the creation of man and the universe, or events from human history. Since the aim of the Qur'an is to guide man, it states or discusses things only to the extent relevant to this aim and leaves out unnecessary and irrelevant details. It also repeats its main theme over and over again in the presentation of each topic.

3.

6.Necessity of the holy Quran: The necessity of the Quran is discussed below:

- i. Blessing of Allah(SWT) to mankind: The holy Quran is the blessing of Allah (SWT) to mankind. It is better than the wealth which we hoard. We are ordered to rejoice for its revelation. Allah says in this regard:

قُلْ بِفَضْلِ اللَّهِ وَبِرَحْمَتِهِ فَبِذَلِكَ فَلْيَفْرَحُوا هُوَ خَيْرٌ مِمَّا يَجْمَعُونَ (58)

Say, "In the bounty of Allah and in His mercy - in that let them rejoice; it is better than what they accumulate."

- ii. Guidance for mankind: Its prospect is to guide human being to the right path, to arouse mankind conscience and to illuminate the human mind. Its instructions are aimed at the general welfare of human beings. Allah says:

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ قَدْ جَاءَتْكُمْ مَوْعِظَةٌ مِنْ رَبِّكُمْ وَشِفَاءٌ لِمَا فِي الصُّدُورِ وَهُدًى وَرَحْمَةٌ لِّلْمُؤْمِنِينَ

O mankind, there has to come to you instruction from your Lord and healing for what is in the breasts and guidance and mercy for the believers.

- iii. The Healing for heart diseases: The holy Quran cleans the heart from ills like the polytheism and hypocrisy. Allah says:

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ قَدْ جَاءَتْكُمْ مَوْعِظَةٌ مِنْ رَبِّكُمْ وَشِفَاءٌ لِمَا فِي الصُّدُورِ وَهُدًى وَرَحْمَةٌ لِّلْمُؤْمِنِينَ

O mankind, there has to come to you instruction from your Lord and healing for what is in the breasts and guidance and mercy for the believers.

- iv. Main source of Islamic Sharee'ah: The Islamic law is originated from four sources. These are Quran, Sunnah, Ijm'a and Qias. The holy Quran is the most important and main source of them. The Quran says:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَطِيعُوا اللَّهَ وَأَطِيعُوا الرَّسُولَ وَأُولِي الْأَمْرِ مِنْكُمْ فَإِن تَنَازَعْتُمْ فِي شَيْءٍ فَرُدُّوهُ إِلَى اللَّهِ وَالرَّسُولِ إِن كُنتُمْ تُؤْمِنُونَ بِاللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ ذَلِكَ خَيْرٌ وَأَحْسَنُ تَأْوِيلًا

O you who have believed, obey Allah and obey the Messenger and those in authority among you. And if you disagree over anything, refer it to Allah and the Messenger, if you should believe in Allah and the Last Day. That is the best [way] and best in result.

- v. Recitation is the worship: The recitation of the holy Quran in prayer and outside of the prayer is worship. This is why the Prophet (SAW) said:

قال رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم (من قرأ حرفاً من كتاب الله فله به حسنة ، والحسنة بعشر أمثالها لا أقول (الم) حرف ولكن : ألف حرف ولام حرف ، وميم حرف)

“Whoever reads one letter from Allah’s Book will have one good deed, and the good deed is multiplied ten folds. I do not say Alif Lam Mim is one letter. Rather, Alif is a letter, Lam is a letter and Mim is a letter.”

- vi. Tranquility and Peace: The Tranquility and peace will descend on those who recite it. The Messenger of Allah said:

(ما اجتمع قوم في بيت من بيوت الله يتلون كتاب الله ويتدارسونه فيما بينهم إلا نزلت عليهم السكينة وغشيتهم الرحمة وحفتهم الملائكة وذكرهم الله فيمن عنده)

“No group of people meet in one of the houses of Allah (mosques) for the purpose of reciting the Quran and studying it amongst themselves, but tranquillity will descend on them, the Mercy will fill them, the angels will accompany them, and Allah will mention them to those who are with Him (the angels in heaven).” [Muslim].

- vii. Family of Allah: The people who recite , understand and follow the Quran are the family member of Allah (SWA). The Prophet (SAW) said:

قال رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم (إن لله تعالى أهلين من الناس . قالوا : يا رسول الله من هم ؟ قال : هم أهل القرآن أهل الله وخاصته).

Allah's Messenger (SAW) said: Verily Allah has his family members among people. They said: And who are they, O Messenger of Allah? He (SAW) said: They are the people of the Qur'an the people of Allah and his selected ones.

- viii. Intercessor on the Last Day: The holy Quran will intercede on behalf of those people who recited it their worldly life frequently. The Prophet (SAW) said:

(اقرأوا القرآن فإنه يأتي يوم القيامة شفيعاً لأصحابه).

Read the Quran, for it will be a Shafi' (intercessor) for its people (who recite it frequently) on the Day of Resurrection.

7. Authenticity of the holy Qur'an: As the holy Quran is of the essentials of religion, it would be wrong to seek proof for its authenticity. But there is no problem to have a discussion on those proofs.

- Conscience (Aql): It is the demand of conscience to have guidance from the creator, Allah for the creation, human beings through the messengers. Because he did not create them in vain.
- Consensus (Ijma): All the Muslims are unanimously agreed to the fact that the holy Quran is proof in every walk of life and the prime source of legislation.
- Miraculous nature of Quran: The Quran proved that it is a miracle from Allah that it incapacitated people of all the times to produce a copy like it. When it is the state of miraculous nature of the Quran then it necessitates that it must be from Allah. That which is from Allah is undoubted authentic and proof.
- Sunnah: All the evidences proved that Prophet SAAS acted upon Quran. He never refused the practices of Muslims in accordance with the contents of Quran. Rather, he encouraged them for holding it firmly. Our prophet SAAS says in his farewell address that I am leaving two things before you will never be misguided while holding them firmly; the book of Allah and the Hadith of Prophet SAAS.
- Quran: There are many verses in the Quran that establish its authenticity, such as:

1. وَقَالُوا لَوْلَا أُنْزِلَ عَلَيْهِ آيَاتٌ مِنْ رَبِّهِ قُلْ إِنَّمَا الْآيَاتُ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ وَإِنَّمَا أَنَا نَذِيرٌ مُبِينٌ (50) أَوَلَمْ يَكْفِهِمْ أَنَّا أَنْزَلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ يُتْلَى عَلَيْهِمْ إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَرَحْمَةً وَذِكْرَى لِقَوْمٍ يُؤْمِنُونَ

But they say, "Why are not signs sent down to him from his Lord?" Say, "The signs are only with Allah, and I am only a clear Warner." And is it not sufficient for them that we revealed to you the Book which is recited to them? Indeed in that is a mercy and reminder for a people who believe.

Here is mentioned that Quran is the greatest miracle and from Allah. That which is from Allah is authentic.

2. أَوَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُمْ آيَةٌ أَنْ يَعْلَمَهُ عُلَمَاءُ بَنِي إِسْرَائِيلَ

And has it not been a sign to them that it is recognized by the scholars of the Children of Israel? (As Shuara, 197).

In this verse Allah says that the scholars of Bani Israel knew prophet SAAS and the Quran which is also a miracle.

3. وَأُوحِيَ إِلَيَّ هَذَا الْقُرْآنُ لِأُنذِرَكُمْ بِهِ وَمَنْ بَلَغَ

And this Qur'an was revealed to me that I may warn you thereby and whomever it reaches. (Al-Anam,19)

Here Allah says: Quran is revealed to Prophet SAAS from Him.

4. إِنَّا نَحْنُ نَزَّلْنَا الذِّكْرَ وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ (9)

Indeed, it is We who sent down the Qur'an and indeed, We will be its guardian.(Al Hijr,9)

Here Allah says that He himself took the charge of protection and preservation of Quran.

Chapter-2

Wahy (Revelation) of the Holy Qur'an:

1.The meaning of Wahy:

Linguistic meaning: The term “*wahy*” in Arabic means a swift and or secretive transfer of information. It has been used in a number of places in the Qur'an to indicate the following meanings:

- 1) Natural human instincts that Allaah has placed in humans.
- 2) Intuition; a person gets a strong feeling that a certain action is the right to do ,even though there may not any logical evidence for it.
- 3) Instinctual animal habits.
- 4) The natural order and laws of nature.
- 5) Communication by rapid, subtle gestures.
- 6) The process of Allah's command to the angels.
- 7) The whispering and prodding of the devils.
- 8) The process of revelation of Allah's commands to His Prophet , as well as the revelation itself.

Technical Meaning : In the terminology of the *Sharee'ah*, *wahy* is defined as the process by which Allah's word is revealed to one of His prophets. It is also used for the actual word of Allah which has been revealed to one of His prophets.

2.The Various classifications and procedure of Wahy: Allah's word may be revealed to the prophets in two ways: directly, in the form of true dreams or in the form of direct conversations; and indirectly, by way of the angel of revelation, Jibreel. These ways were identified by Allah in the Qur'an as follows:

وَمَا كَانَ لِنَبِيٍّ أَنْ يَكَلِّمَهُ اللَّهُ إِلَّا وَحْيًا أَوْ مِنْ وَرَاءِ حِجَابٍ أَوْ يُرْسِلَ رَسُولًا فَيُوحِيَ بِأُذُنِهِ مَا يَشَاءُ إِنَّهُ عَلِيُّ حَكِيمٍ-الشورى-51

“Allaah does not speak to a person except by inspiration (wahy), or from behind a veil or by sending a messenger who then reveals (yoohee) by His permission whatever He wishes. Verily, He is most High and Wise.”

Direct Revelations

A portion of Allaah's revelation was communicated directly to the prophets without any intermediary. This form of revelation came either as visions during a prophet's sleep, or in the form of words spoken by Allaah from behind a veil of light.

(a) True Dreams: Divine commands were communicated to the prophets in their sleep in the form of dreams that gave them accurate glimpses of future events. 'Aa'ishah, said, *“Revelation to the Prophet (r) first began as righteous visions in his sleep. Whenever he saw a vision, it would occur as surely as the break of the day.”* This form of revelation was a very gentle means of preparing the Prophet (r) for the tremendous burden of revelation in the waking state. Sometimes visions directed the prophets to perform certain acts, as in the case of Prophet Ibraaheem, who is recorded in the Qur'aan as saying to his son Ismaa'eel,

فَلَمَّا بَلَغَ مَعَهُ السَّعْيَ قَالَ يَا بُنَيَّ إِنِّي أَرَى فِي الْمَنَامِ أَنِّي أَذْبَحُكَ فَانْظُرْ مَاذَا تَرَى الصافات-102

“O my dear son, verily, I saw in dream that I am to sacrifice you. What is your opinion?” Ismaa'eel's reply is recorded as follows:

قَالَ يَا أَبَتِ افْعَلْ مَا تُؤْمَرُ سَتَجِدُنِي إِنْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ مِنَ الصَّابِرِينَ-الصافات-102

“O dear father, do as you are commanded. You will find me, Allaah willing, among those who are patient.

Both Prophet Ibraaheem and his son knew that the vision was a divine command which they had to fulfill. The only soorah of the Qur'aan reported to have been revealed in a vision was Soorah al-Kawthar. The sahaabee Anas ibn Maalik said, *“Once while Allaah's Messenger (r) was among us in the masjid, he dozed off, then raised his head, smiling. I asked him, ‘What has amused you, O Messenger of Allaah (r)?’ He replied, ‘A soorah has just been revealed to me.’ Then he recited, ‘In the*

name of Allaah, the Most Compassionate, the Most Merciful,

إِنَّا أَعْطَيْنَاكَ الْكَوْثَرَ (1) فَصَلِّ لِرَبِّكَ وَانْحَرْ (2) إِنَّ شَانِئَكَ هُوَ الْأَبْتَرُ (3)

“Verily, I have given you Kawthar (the fountain in paradise) so pray to your Lord and sacrifice. Verily, it is your enemy who will be cut off.”

It should be noted that true dreams are not restricted to the prophets only. However, true dreams of common people are not the same as the true dreams of the prophets. Every dream of the prophets was a true dream; hence, their dreams are a reliable source of guidance. On the other hand, ordinary persons only know that their dreams are true if and when they come true. The ordinary person's dreams are mostly a mixture of recollections, fantasies, and evil dreams implanted by the devils, with occasional true dreams. Hence, one cannot claim any of one's dreams to be true before its occurrence.

(b) Divine Speech: The second method of direct communication by Allaah with His prophets took the form of direct speech, in which the actual words of Allaah were spoken to the prophets. In this case, the prophets were in a waking state, but a veil of light separated them from Allaah and prevented them from seeing Him. This form of communication only occurred with two prophets, as far as we know. The first of those was Prophet Moosaa, about whom Allaah stated the following in the Qur'aan:

وَلَمَّا جَاءَ مُوسَى لِمِيقَاتِنَا وَكَلَّمَهُ رَبُّهُ

“And when Moosaa came to Our appointed place and his Lord spoke to him...”

This method of communication was apparently the main way in which Prophet Moosaa received revelation, hence his title “*Kaleemullah*” (the one to whom Allaah spoke). The second prophet to listen to the direct speech of Allaah was Prophet Muhammad (r). However, this phenomenon occurred on only one occasion during his prophethood; at the time of the Prophet's ascension up into the heavens (*Mi'raaj*)

Indirect Revelation

The vast majority of Allaah's revelation was conveyed to the prophets by way of the angel of revelation, Jibreel. The final book of revelation, the Qur'aan, was revealed in this way for the most part. This form of revelation reached the Prophet (r) in two ways: either in the form of the reverberating sound like the gong of a bell, or in the form of the direct speech of the angel.

In the first case, the angel remained in a spiritual state and the Prophet (r) was required to raise spiritually to a suitable state in which to receive the revelation. This method was extremely taxing on the Prophet (r). During it the voice of the angel resembled the loud ringing of a giant bell. The *sahaabee* al-Haarith ibn Hishaam once asked the Prophet (r) to describe how the revelation came to him. The Prophet (r) replied,

أَحْيَانًا يَأْتِينِي مِثْلَ صَلْصَلَةِ الْجَرَسِ وَهُوَ أَشَدُّ عَلَيَّ فَيُفْصِمُ عَلَيَّ وَقَدْ وَعَيْتُ عَنْهُ مَا قَال

“Sometimes it comes to me like the ringing of a bell—this is the most severe form for me—then the ringing ceases and I have understood what (the angel) said.”

‘Aa’ishah described the intensity of this form as follows: “I have seen him when revelation (*wahy*) descended upon him on an extremely cold day, yet when it stopped his forehead would be dripping with sweat.”

The second method was much easier for the Prophet (r) to bear than the first. In this case, the angel would leave the spiritual world, appear to the Prophet (r) in human form and pass on the revelation in the medium of human speech. The Prophet (r) described this form to al-Haarith ibn Hishaam as follows:

وَأَحْيَانًا يَتَمَثَّلُ لِي الْمَلَكُ رَجُلًا فَيَكَلِّمُنِي فَأَعِي مَا يَقُولُ

“Occasionally the angel appears before me in the form of a man and speaks to me, and I grasp all that he says.”

3.Revelation of Quran to the angel: We know that Allah (SWT) revealed the Quran by way of angel of revelation, Gibrael .But the scholars have difference of opinion as to how Gibrael took the Quran from Allah (SWT).

- ✓ Ahl as- Sunnah wa-Al Jam’ah believes that the Quran is the speech of Allah which can be heard Allah spoke the Quran to Gibrael in a manner that is befitting Him, not similar or comparable to human speech. In other words , Gibrael heard the Quran from Allah (SWT) directly.

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ إِذَا تَكَلَّمَ اللَّهُ بِالْوَحْيِ سَمِعَ أَهْلُ السَّمَاءِ لِلْسَّمَاءِ صَلَاصَةً كَجَرِّ السَّنَسِلَةِ عَلَى الصَّفَا فَيُصْعَقُونَ فَلَا يَرَالُونَ كَذَلِكَ حَتَّى يَأْتِيَهُمْ جِبْرِيلُ حَتَّى إِذَا جَاءَهُمْ جِبْرِيلُ فَرَعَ عَنْ قُلُوبِهِمْ قَالُوا فَيَقُولُونَ يَا جِبْرِيلُ مَاذَا قَالَ رَبُّكَ فَيَقُولُ الْحَقُّ فَيَقُولُونَ الْحَقَّ الْحَقُّ

The Prophet (SAW)said;“When Allaah, the Most High, speaks the revelation (wahy), the inhabitants of

heaven hear the heavens tremble with a sound like the rattling of a chain across a smooth stone. They are stunned and faint, and they remain in that state until Jibreel comes to them. When Jibreel comes to them, the fear is removed from their hearts. They say, ‘O Jibreel! What did your Lord say?’ He says, ‘The truth.’ Then they say, ‘The truth, the truth.’ ”

This Hadith is explicit in that Allah speaks to him with inspiration.

Apart from the proofs from Quran and Sunnah, there exists narrations from such scholars as Imam Ahmad, al-Bukharee and al –Byhaqee. Imam Ahmad said: Jibreel heard the Quran from Allah (SWT),Mohammad (SAW) heard the Quran from Jibreel,the companions heard the Quran from Mohammad (SA W) .Therefore the Quran is not created.

Imam Al-Bayhaqee Said in explaining the verse,

إِنَّا أَنْزَلْنَاهُ فِي لَيْلَةِ الْقَدْرِ

“Verily, We have revealed it in the Night Decree”

This verse means –and Allah knows best-We made our angel hear it and understand, and revealed with him what he heard, and so the angel descended with the revelation from a higher place (the skies)to a lower one(the earth).

- ✓ Some scholars claimed that Gibreel took the Quran from Lauh Mahfoodh. They mentioned the following verses as their evidence:

بَلْ هُوَ قُرْآنٌ مَجِيدٌ (21) فِي لَوْحٍ مَحْفُوظٍ (22)

Nay,this is a glorious Quran,(Inscribed) in a Tablet Preserved.

However, these verses do not explicitly mention that Gibreel took the Quran from Lauh Mahfoodh.

- ✓ Other scholars, primary those of Ash'arees, claimed that Jibreel was inspired the meaning of the Quran, but the wording either from Jibreel or Mohammad(SAW).

This opinion is rejected outright, for its adherents deny what has affirmed for Himself, namely that the Quran is His speech that He spoke in a manner or way that befits Him. To say that the wording of the Quran is from Jibreel or Mohammad denies the whole concept of kalam (speech) of Allah, and the miraculous nature of the Quran. Infact, this type of inspiration for Sunnah of Prophet only, and not for the Quran.

4. Stages of Revelation: The holy Quran was revealed in three distinct stages, to the vast majority of scholars:

The First stage

The Quran was written on the *Lauh al Mahfoodh* (The preserved Tablet) which is with Allah. But how and when it was written is known only to Allah. He says in this regard:

بَلْ هُوَ قُرْآنٌ مَجِيدٌ (21) فِي لَوْحٍ مَحْفُوظٍ (22)

Nay! This is indeed a glorious Quran. (Inscribed) in the *Lauh al Mahfoodh*. (Al Buroj, 21-22)

The wisdom behind this stage of revelation of Quran is to show the believers its authenticity that it was written down even before its revelation in a place which guarantees safety and where everything –small or big will happen from the creation of earth and heaven until the end of the time is recorded. This is also a manifestation of the infinite knowledge of Allah.

The second Stage

From *Lauh al Mahfoodh*, Allah revealed The Quran to the heaven closer to earth, in a place called “The House of Honor” (*Baitul Izzah*). This revelation occurred in Ramdan on the Night of decree. The Quran states:

شَهْرُ رَمَضَانَ الَّذِي أُنْزِلَ فِيهِ الْقُرْآنُ -The month of Ramdan is the month in which the Quran was revealed..... (Al Baqarah, 185)

It also states, إِنَّا أَنْزَلْنَاهُ فِي لَيْلَةٍ مُبَارَكَةٍ

We revealed it on a blessed night..... (Ad- Dukhan, 3)

In explanation of the verses Ibn Abbas says: The whole Quran was sent down to the lower heaven on the night of decree. The place the Quran was revealed to was “Baitul Izzah”

The third stage

This is final stage of the revelation of Quran. The angel Gabriel brought it to Prophet Mohammad SAAS in piecemeal fashion catering the needs of human begins. Allah says:

وَإِنَّهُ لَتَنْزِيلُ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ (192) نَزَلَ بِهِ الرُّوحُ الْأَمِينُ (193) عَلَى قَلْبِكَ لِتَكُونَ مِنَ الْمُنْذِرِينَ (194) بِلِسَانٍ عَرَبِيٍّ مُبِينٍ

And indeed, the Qur'an is the revelation of the Lord of the worlds. The Trustworthy Spirit has brought it down upon your heart, [O Muhammad] - that you may be of the warners - In a clear Arabic language. (Ash Shuara, 192-94)

Ibn Abbas says:"Then whenever Allah wished to inspire something (from Quran), He would inspire". In another narration: ..."it was then revealed piece meal over a period of twenty years".

This gradual revelation took place over a period of twenty three years, according to the strongest opinion. Some say twenty years and yet other group twenty five.

5. Wisdom behind gradual revelation: There is some wisdom behind the revelation of Quran in gradual manner which are as follows:

- To strengthen the resolve of the prophet: The disbelievers of the time of the Prophet SAAS ridiculed him and claimed that he was a soccer, a crazy man or that he was possessed by the Jinn. He was distressed for their mockery. But Allah reaffirmed in his determination and zeal by the continual revelation of Quran. This is what Allah alludes in the Quran. He says:

وَقَالَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا لَوْلَا نُزِّلَ عَلَيْهِ الْقُرْآنُ جُمْلَةً وَاحِدَةً كَذَلِكَ لِنُثَبِّتَ بِهِ فُؤَادَكَ وَرَتَّلْنَاهُ تَرْتِيلًا (32)

And those who disbelieve say, "Why was the Qur'an not revealed to him all at once?" Thus [it is] that We may strengthen thereby your heart. And We have spaced it distinctly. (Al Furqan-32)

- To make easy memorization and understanding of Quran: The piecemeal revelation of the Quran made it easier for the companions to understand, memorize and implement the portions that were revealed. If the Quran had been all at once, it might have been difficult for the companions to understand all of its verses properly. Yet with gradual revelation, the companions understood and implemented the Quran correctly.
- To prove the truthfulness of Prophet SAAS: The idolaters and the people of book used to ask the prophet SAAS questions in order to outwit him but every time Allah would reply

to their queries. Whenever a situation or crisis arose, the Quran would clearly lay out the situation. Allah says:

قَدْ سَمِعَ اللَّهُ قَوْلَ الَّتِي تُجَادِلُكَ فِي زَوْجِهَا وَتَشْتَكِي إِلَى اللَّهِ وَاللَّهُ يَسْمَعُ تَحَاوُرَكُمَا إِنَّ اللَّهَ سَمِيعٌ بَصِيرٌ

Certainly has Allah heard the speech of the one who argues with you, [O Muhammad], concerning her husband and directs her complaint to Allah. And Allah hears your dialogue; indeed, Allah is Hearing and Seeing. (Al Mujadalah-1)

Therefore, the fact the Quran came down immediately to cater to the questions and problems of the people proved that it was in fact the word of Allah, revealed through the Prophet SAAS.

- To prove the miraculous nature of the Quran: One of the most outstanding miracles of the Quran was that it was revealed over a period of two decades catering a plethora of situations and commanding the Prophet SAAS and the believers to a course of action yet not a single of its six thousand plus verses is contradicted by another. To add to miraculous nature, the order and arrangement of verses were not done chronologically, rather the prophet would instruct his companions of the location of any new verse. The Quran was literally assembled out of the fragmental revelation.
- To reveal the laws of Islam in gradual manner: Among the blessings of Allah for human being is that He revealed to them the laws of Islam gradually and thus made it easier for them to adopt these laws.
- To ease the revelation process on the Prophet SAAS: The process of *wahi* was a difficult one for the Prophet SAAS. At times he used to sweat profusely, even on a cold night, because of the severity of the inspiration. Had the Quran been revealed all at once, it might have been too difficult for the Prophet SAAS to bear.

First Revelation: There are four opinions regarding first revelation that Prophet (SAAS) received.

1. First five verses of Surah Al-`Alaq:

اقْرَأْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ (1) خَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ عَلَقٍ (2) اقْرَأْ وَرَبُّكَ الْأَكْرَمُ (3) الَّذِي عَلَّمَ بِالْقَلَمِ (4) عَلَّمَ الْإِنْسَانَ مَا لَمْ يَعْلَمْ

Recite in the name of your Lord who Created man from a clinging substance. Recite, and your Lord is the most Generous who taught by the pen. Taught man that which he knew not. (96:1-5)

The proof for this opinion is the hadith narrated by Al Bukhari from Aisha (R) in which she said: The commencement of the Divine Inspiration to Allah's Messenger (SAAS) was in the form of good dreams which came true like bright daylight, and then the love of seclusion was bestowed upon him. He used to go in seclusion in the cave of Hira where he used to worship

(Allah alone) continuously for many days before his desire to see his family. He used to take with him the journey food for the stay and then come back to (his wife) Khadija to take his food likewise again till suddenly the Truth descended upon him while he was in the cave of Hira. The angel came to him and asked him to read. The Prophet (SAAS) replied, "I do not know how to read." The Prophet (SAAS) added, "The angel caught me (forcefully) and pressed me so hard that I could not bear it any more. He then released me and again asked me to read and I replied, 'I do not know how to read.' Thereupon he caught me again and pressed me a second time till I could not bear it any more. He then released me and again asked me to read but again I replied, 'I do not know how to read (or what shall I read)?' Thereupon he caught me for the third time and pressed me, and then released me and said,

'Read in the name of your Lord, who has created (all that exists), created man from a clot. Read! And your Lord is the Most Generous who taught by the pen, Taught man that which he knew not.

2. Surah Al-Muddathir:

The proof for this is based on another hadith in al Bukhari, in which Jabir ibn Abdillah was asked "what part of the Quran was revealed first?" He replied: **يَا أَيُّهَا الْمُدَّثِّرُ** (Shura Muddathir) was revealed first. The questioner then said: I was informed that it was **اقْرَأْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ**. Jabir replied: I am only telling you that which I heard from Prophet (SAAS), for he said: "While I was walking, all of a sudden I heard a voice from the sky. I looked up and saw the same angel who had visited me at the cave of Hira' sitting on a chair between the sky and the earth. I got afraid of him and came back home and said, 'Wrap me (in blankets).' And then Allah revealed **يَا أَيُّهَا الْمُدَّثِّرُ** (O You enveloped).

This hadith actually means which Surah was revealed first in its entirety or after the pause of revelation. It does not mean that it was revealed first.

3. Surah Fatihah:

There was a narration in al –Byhaqee that states the first revelation was Surah al-Fatiha. However this narration is not authentic, there it does not hold any weight.

4. Basmalah (Bismillahir Rahmanir Rahim):

Another hadith states the first verse revealed was *basmalah* but this hadith too is not authentic and can't be taken as proof.

The last revelation: There are a number of opinions concerning the last revelation.

1. Al –Bukhari and Tabrani narrate from Ibn Abbas that the last verse revealed to Prophet(SAAS) was

وَاتَّقُوا يَوْمًا تُرْجَعُونَ فِيهِ إِلَى اللَّهِ ثُمَّ تُوَفَّى كُلُّ نَفْسٍ مَا كَسَبَتْ وَهُمْ لَا يُظْلَمُونَ

And fear a Day when you will be returned to Allah. Then every soul will be compensated for what it earned, and they will not be treated unjustly.(2:281)

2. Another narration, also by Bukhari from Ibn abbas states that the last verse revealed was the “Verse of Interest”

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ وَذَرُوا مَا بَقِيَ مِنَ الرِّبَا إِن كُنْتُمْ مُؤْمِنِينَ

O you who have believed, fear Allah and give up what remains [due to you] of interest, if you should be believers.(2:278)

3. “Verse Loaning”.

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِذَا تَدَايَنْتُمْ بِدِينٍ إِلَى أَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى فَاكْتُبُوهُ

O you who have believed, when you contract a debt for a specified term, write it down. (2:282)

4. Verse of Khalalah.

يَسْتَفْتُونَكَ قُلِ اللَّهُ يُفْتِيكُمْ فِي الْكَلَالَةِ

They request from you a [legal] ruling. Say, "Allah gives you a ruling concerning one having neither descendants nor ascendants (4:176)

5. Last two verses of Surah At –Tawbah.

لَقَدْ جَاءَكُمْ رَسُولٌ مِنْ أَنْفُسِكُمْ.....

Verily there has come messenger from amongst yourself...(9:18-129)

6. Surah An-Nasr:

7. The last was

وَمَنْ يَقْتُلْ مُؤْمِنًا مُّتَعَمِّدًا فِجْرًاؤُهُ جَهَنَّمَ خَالِدًا فِيهَا

But whoever kills a believer intentionally - his recompense is Hell, wherein he will abide eternally, (4:93)

8. Surah Al-Maidah.
9. Last verse of Surah Al –Kahaf
10. Last revealed was

الْيَوْمَ أَكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِينَكُمْ وَأَتِمَمْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ نِعْمَتِي وَرَضِيتُ لَكُمُ الْإِسْلَامَ دِينًا

This day I have perfected for you your religion and completed My favor upon you and have approved for you Islam as religion.(5:3)

Chapter 3

The Verses of the Qur'aan

Meaning of Verse:

By 'verse' is meant what is known as an '*aayah*'. This word, linguistically, has a number of meanings such as: Sign or indication, admonition or lesson, miracle and verse or sentence

When used in Islaamic sciences, it is defined to be a part of the Qur'aan composed of sequential letters and words, separate from what is before it and after it, with a beginning and end, occupying a specific place in a specific soorah.

The arrangement of the verses:

Even though there is a difference of opinion over the actual verse numbering. There is no difference of opinion over the fact that the arrangement and order of the verses in each soorah is from the Prophet himself. The scholars of Islaam have agreed on this point. Aboo Ja'far ibn Zubayr (d. 807 A.H) said,

“The arrangement of the verses in the soorahs in a matter which is from the command of the Prophet and we cannot question it (i.e exercise ijuhaad in it). This is a matter in which there is no difference of opinion among the Muslims”

The Prophet used to mention to the scribe writing the verse where to put the verse in the Qur'aan. He did not used to do this by his own judgment, for Jibreel used to tell him. And Jibreel was inspired by Allah with this knowledge.

‘Uthmaan ibn Abee la-‘Aas reported that he was once sitting by the Prophet when he notices that the Prophet raised his eyes and fixed his gaze (an indication that he was being inspired), the he said, “Jibreel came to me and commanded me to put this verse at a certain point in the soorah”.

“Allah commands you with justice” [16:90]

In other words, the Prophet was told not only in which soorah to place the verse but also in which portion of the soorah to do so.

Abdullah ibn az-Zubayr was reading the Qur'aan when he came across this verse,

“And those of you who die and leave behind their wives should bequeath for them a year’s maintenance and residence, without turning them out.” [2:240]

He went to Uthmaan ibn Affaan, and asked him, “This verse has been abrogated by the verses after it, so why do you write it?” He answered, “O mu nephew, I will not change anything from its place.” In this narration, Uthmaan signified that he knew the place of the verse, but he was not willing to leave anything out that the Prophet had not ordered him to.

Apan from this proof, the fact that the Prophet used to recite complete soorah in the prayer and to the Companions individually, shows that the arrangement of the verses must have been taught by the Prophet to the Companions. In all of the prayers in which the recitation is aloud, the Prophet would have had to recite various soorahs. There are reports, for example, that he recited Soorah Sajdah in Fajr, and he recited al –Baqarah, and Aali-Imraan, and Niisaa’, and Araaf , and many more soorah in the prayer, and he recited Soorah Qaaf more than once during the Friday sennens. In addition, the Prophet used to recite the entire Qur’an during the month of Ramadan and this was witnessed by Zayd ibn Thaabit. Therefore, the companions must have heard the various verses put together to form the soorah.

This is why as Snyootee said , “The recitation of the Prophet in front of the gatherings of the Companions proves that the arrangement of the verses is form him, and the Companions could not change the order of the verses from what the Prophet recited . Therefore, the knowledge of the order of the verses is *mutaauaatir*.” This is reflected in the fact that there is absolutely no known difference if opinion in the arrangement of the verses for each soorah.

Meaning of Soorah:

The word soorah means an enclosure or fencing, such as the walls around a city. It is also used to denote an elevated plan.

When applied to Islamic Sciences, it signifies a specific group of verses in the Qur'aan, arranged in a specific manner close its inhabitants.”

The Arrangements of the Soorahs:

The scholars of Islaam have agreed (ijmaa') to the fact that it is obligatory to follow the arrangements of the soorahs in the writing of the mus-haf, and that it is recommend (but not obligatory) to follow this arrangement in the recitation of the Qur'aan, whether this recitation occurs during the prayer or outside of it. However they have disagreed concerning the origin of this arrangement into three opinions.

- 1) The first opinion states that the arrangement of the soorahs was from the ijtihaad of the Companions. In other words, when Zayd compiled the official mus-haf, he employed his own ijtihaad in the arrangement of the soorahs, and the other Companions agreed to this. This is the opinion of Imaam Maalik (d. 179 A. H.) and Aboo Bakr al-Baqillaanee (d. 403 A. H.)

The proof that is given for this opinion is the fact that the difference Companions had different arrangements of the soorahs in their respective mus-hafs. For example, 'Alee's mus-haf was arranged in chronological order, starting with Soorahs al-Iqra, then al-Muddathir, and so on. Both of mus-hafs of Ubay ibn ka'ab and Ibn Mas'ood started with al-Baqarah, then an-Nisaa, then Aali-Imraan. These differences, according to the proponents of this opinion, show that the arrangement of the soorahs was not from the Prophet (SM), for had it been so, these Companions would have written their mus-hafs with the proper arrangement of the soorahs.

However, this is the weakest of the three opinions, since the mus-hafs of the Companions were personal and were not meant for others to read. Most of them were in fact incomplete, and such do not constitute any proof. Apart from that, these mus-hafs were written during the lifetime of the Prophet (SM), when the revelation of the Qur'aan had not even been completed. Therefore, it would not even have been possible for these mus-hafs to have been arranged in the correct order.

- 2) The second opinion claims that part of the arrangement was done by the Prophet (SM), and part by the ijtihaad of the Companions. The followers of the opinion, however, have disagreed as to how many soorahs were arranged by the Prophet (SM) and how many by the Companions.

The most common opinion amongst those groups is that all the soorahs were arranged by the Prophet (SM) except for Soorahs at-Tawbah and al-Anfaal. As proof, they use the following narration:

Ibn Abbaas narrates that he asked 'Uthmaan. “Why did you pair al-Anfaal, even though it is from the mathaani with at-Tawbah, which is from the mi'een. And why did you not write the basmalah between them, and put both of them in the tiwaal soorahs”. Uthmaan answered, “The soorahs used to be revealed to the Prophet (SM), so whenever something was revealed he would

call a scribe and tell him, 'Put this verse in the soorahs in which such and such is mentioned.' Soorah al-Anfaal was one of first soorahs to be revealed in Madeenah, and Soorahs at-Tawbah was one of the last parts of Quraan, and its story was similar to it (i.e., Soorahs at-Tawbah resembled Soorah al-Anfaal), so I thought that it was part of it. The Prophet SAAS passed away before I could ask him concerning this issue, so because of this I put the two of these together, and did not write basmalah between them and put them amongst the seven *tiwaal* soorahs.

This narration would be a very explicit proof for those who hold the opinion, if it was not for the fact that the above narration is weak. Therefore, this narration cannot be taken as proof in this matter.

This opinion, that all of the Quraan except for Soorahs at-Tawbah and al-Anfaal was arranged by Prophet SAAS, was held by As-Suyoote, (who claimed that this was the opinion of the majority scholars) and al-Byhaqee and others

It should be pointed out that the proponents of both of the above opinions claim that the present arrangement must be followed, since the companions all agreed to it (*ijmaa*)

3) The last opinion states that the Soorah order was from the command of the Prophet SAAS. In other words, the arrangement of Soorahs was understood by the companions since the Prophet SAAS taught them this, and this is why Uthmaan arranged the soorahs in the present arrangement.

This is perhaps the strongest opinion on the matter. This is because the Prophet SAAS used to recite the soorah to the companions in a specific order, and he mentioned the order of some of them in certain hadeeth. For example, he said, "Recite the two bright ones: al-Baqarah and Aali-imraan, and he said, I have given in place of the Torah the seven *tiwaal* and I have given in place of the Psalms the *mi'een* and I have given in place of the Gospel the *mathaani* and I was honored over others with *mufassal*. It clearly shows that the Quraan had been arranged into some order by the prophet SASS

Also, when the Prophet SAAS recited the Quraan to Jibreel every year, he must have recited it in a particular order and Zayd was present when he recited it. When Othman compiled the *mus-haf* Zayd would have used the same order that he had heard from the Prophet SAAS. Another proof is that none of the companions objected to this order. Therefore, arrangement of soorahs must have been known to the companions and that is why they agreed to it. (*ijmaa*)

Perhaps the strongest proof is the narration of Hudhayfah at-Thaqafee in which he said, I asked the companions (during the life time of Prophet SAAS) 'How do you divide the Quraan? They replied, We break into three soorahs, then five, then seven, then nine, then eleven, then thirteen, then the *mufassal* from Qaaf to the end. ""In other words, the Companions would recite the Qur'aan in a specific order so that they could finish it every week. This narration shows that the

arrangement of the *soorahs* was known to all the companions even during the life of the Prophet (SAAS).

Imam Al-karmaanee said, "The arrangement of *soorahs* is from Allaah, and in the Qur'aan is written in the *Lauh al Mahfoodh* in this arrangement. It was recited to Jibreel by the Prophet (SAW) in this order every year, and he (SAW) recited it twice the year he died. Aboo Bakr al-Anbaaree (d. 328 A.H.) said, "The whole Qur'aan was revealed to the lower heavens, then it was revealed gradually, over a period of twenty or so years. A *soorah* would be revealed in response to an occurrence, and a verse in response to a happening. Jibreel used to inform the Prophet (SAW) of the arrangement and place of the verses and *soorahs*, so the arrangement of *soorahs* is like the arrangement of the verses and words all of it is from Prophet (SAW). Therefore, whoever changes the arrangement of a *soorah* to a place before or after what it should be has ruined the arrangement of the Qur'aan." Al- Hamad writes, "The proofs given (by the proponents of the second opinion) are not explicit, and the possibility remains that the Companions took this arrangement from the Prophet (SAW), and this is the correct view..."

In fact, many of the scholars have discussed the wisdom behind the present arrangement of the *soorahs*. The majority of *tafseers* also discuss the relationship between the *soorahs*. In fact, as Suyooti wrote a multi-volume work solely on this topic, entitled *Tanaasiq ad-Durar fi Tanaasub as-Suwar*.

The Classification of the Soorahs

The *soorahs* of the Qur'aan are grouped into four categories, the *tiwaal* (long) *soorahs*, the *mi'een* (hundred) *soorahs*, the *mathaani* (oft-recited) *soorahs* and the *mufassal* (dis-jointed) *soorahs*.

These categories are based on a *hadeeth* of the Prophet (SAW) in which he said, "I have been given in place of the Torah the seven *tiwaal*, and I have been given in place of the Psalms the *mi'een*, and I have been given in place of the Gospel the *mathaani*, and I was honoured over the others with the *mufassal*."

1) **The *tiwaal*soorahs:** These are the first seven *soorahs* in the Qur'aan after the *Faatihah*. Some have added at-Tawbah as included in the *tiwaal* since there is no *basmalah* that separates it from *Soorah al-Anfaal*. They have been called *tiwaal* because they are the longest *soorahs* in the Qur'aan.

2) **The *mi-eeen*:** These are the *soorahs* that have over or around a hundred verses, hence their name.

3) **The *mathaam*:** These *soorahs* are the oft-repeated ones since they are recited in prayers more often than the longer one. They occur after *mi-eeen*.

4)The mufassal: These soorahs are called disjointed or broken because of the frequent occurrence of the basmallah. They start, according to the strongest opinion, from Qaaf (or, according to another person, al-Hujuraat) and finish with an-Naas.

As for the particular soorahs that qualify as mi-een and mathaani, there does not appear to be any consensus. Some have said that the mi-een soorahs end at Soorah Faatir.

This would then imply that tiwaal are the soorahs from al-Baqarah to at-Tawbah; the mi-een from Yoonus to al-Faatir; the mathaani from Ya-Seen to al-Hujurat and the mufassal from Qaaf to an-Naas. Again, this classification is not agreed upon by the scholars.

Other Classifications

The Quran has also been divided into sections to facilitate reading. These divisions have been adopted to assist the completion of the Quran in a certain number of days. The ones that are more common in the mus-hafs of today are as follows:

1)Manzil: The Quran is divided into seven manzils, so that if a person wishes to finish the Quran in one week, he may read one manzil a day.

Most of the companions used to finish the Quran in one week. The narration quoted earlier from Hudhayfah shows this: “ I asked the companions of the Prophet how they used to divide the Quran(for reading purposes). They responded, Three soorahs, then five soorahs, then seven soorahs, then nine soorahs, then eleven soorahs, then thirteen soorahs, then the mufassal from Qaaf to the end.”In other words, the first day of the week they would recite al-Baqarah, Aali-Imraan and an-Nisaa; on the second day, the next five soorahs and so on, so that the recitation of the Quran would be finished weekly.

In the mus-hafs of today, the manzils are different from this narration. This division of the Quran into manzils is not present in most mus-hafs printed in Arab countries.

2)Juz: The Quran is also divided into thirty parts, each of which is called a juz. This is done in order to facilitate its reading in one month. In certain non-Arab countries, this division is called a sipaara.

3) Hizb: The mus-hafs printed in Arab countries are typically divided into hizbs. The Qur’aan is composed of sixty hizbs, and thus every juz contains two hizbs. The beginning of each juz is also the beginning of a hizb, and the middle of a juz is the beginning of another hizb. Each hizb is further divided into quarters called ruba. Thus, each juz contains eight ruba’s.

4)Ruku: The mus-hafs printed in the Indian subcontinent are typically divided into rukus, each equivalent to one or two paragraphs of text. The ruku is accompanied by three numbers. The top number denotes the number of the ruku with respect to that particular soorah. The middle number

indicates the number of verses in that ruku. The bottom number of the ruku with respect to the juz in which it occurs.